

1.1 The General Idea

By at least one estimate, 3 crore PowerPoint presentations are created every day. Not using presentation tools right—which roughly translates to “PowerPoint abuse”—is a genuine issue. Here are some symptoms that you’re not putting up a good presentation:

- Your audience falls asleep without warning.
- Then, your audience starts snoring
- Worse, they later report they’ve had daymares where numbers began to crawl under their skin, and trend-lines became arrows that struck them in the left kidney (terrible for those who’ve donated their right one).

On a serious note, we must emphasise two things: that presentation abuse is a genuine problem for both presenter and audience, and that even so, presentations are a reality, they are a necessity, and used well, can inform—and impress people with that information.

Now here’s from an obscure Web site whose credentials we have no idea about:

“Research has shown that presenters using visuals conduct meetings in 28 percent less time and get proposals approved twice as often.”

That, of course, is a pitch for some product or the other. There’s no clarity on what research has proved the 28 per cent figure. Still, we get the idea that it’s a given in the corporate world that presentations, when done skilfully:

- Save time in terms of not having to explain data verbally
- Make meetings more interesting
- Sum up observations and projections in a formal way
- Make for better recall: you’re more likely to remember a trend-line that said sales dipped in June than a drab statement to that effect

... And much more.